

Dexter Williams

PHD STUDENT · INFORMATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Morgridge Hall, 1205 University Avenue, Madison, WI 53706

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Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison

PHD IN INFORMATION

- Advisor: Professor Jodi Schneider.
- Research Interests: Argument Mining, Computational Argumentation, AI and Law.
- 4.0 GPA

Madison, WI

Aug. 2025 - Present

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

PHD IN INFORMATICS

- Advisor: Professor Jodi Schneider.
- 4.0 GPA

Champaign, IL

Aug. 2024 - July 2025

University of St Andrews

BSC IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND PHILOSOPHY (JOINT HONOURS)

- First Class (3.9 GPA).

St Andrews, Scotland, UK

Sep. 2018 - May 2022

Research Experience

Project Assistant: University of Wisconsin-Madison

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR JODI SCHNEIDER

- Support for a Second Edition of the Argumentation Mining monograph.
- Wrote an appendix for a book on argument mining, that documents existing corpora, and developed a website equivalent of the appendix.
- Acquired copyright permissions for the 100+ figures used in the book.
- Developed a data pipeline that measures the agreement of databases on the retraction status of scientific articles.

Madison, WI

2025-Present

Research Intern: Boise State University

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR CASEY KENNINGTON

- Joined the Retico team at Boise State University for 1 month to aid in the research and development of state-of-the-art incremental processing systems.
- Developed two new modules for Retico to handle speech diarization and automatic speech recognition.

Boise, ID

2025

Research Assistant: University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR JODI SCHNEIDER

- Provided feedback for a new edition of a book on argument mining.
- Read and categorized 100+ papers on argument mining to assist in the writing of a new chapter.
- Funded by the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign Campus Research Board, \$14,714.

Champaign, IL

2025

Research Assistant: University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR BERTRAM LUDÄSCHER

- Joined the explainable AI through computational argumentation (XAI-CA) project, which explores how argumentation can aid in explainability.
- Applied relation-based argument mining to US-legal documents to automatically construct structured argumentation frameworks.
- Funded by the 2025 Cardiff University-University of Illinois System Joint Research and Innovation Seed Grants Program.

Champaign, IL

2025

Undergraduate Research Assistant: University of St Andrews

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR IAN GENT

- Tested variants of Sudoku in a research project that aimed to provide human explanations of solutions to pen and paper puzzles.

St Andrews, Scotland, UK

2020

Undergraduate Research Assistant: University of St Andrews

St Andrews, Scotland, UK

SUPERVISOR: DR. KASIM TERZIĆ

2019-2020

- Developed a program used by the Marine Biology department to automatically identify seal populations in aerial photographs.

Professional Experience

Software Engineer/Consultant

Bath, England, UK

CAPGEMINI ENGINEERING

2022-2024

- Joined the development team for a large rail project.
- Writing and testing the formal specification of the project.
- Implemented specification in Ada SPARK.
- Tested the project using a suite of tools developed under the HICLASS Research Programme.

Data Science and Innovation Intern

Leeds, England, UK

NATIONAL HEALTH SERVICE (NHS) DIGITAL

2021

- Joined the reproducible analytical pipelines team at NHS Digital for ten weeks.
- Produced four guides that teach good software engineering practices.
- Investigated existing PySpark libraries to find a simple and reproducible way for teams to implement basic metadata input validation in their projects.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant: University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, IL

INFORMATION SCIENCE 203: ANALYTICAL FOUNDATIONS FOR INFORMATION PROBLEMS

2024-2025

- Two semesters teaching 80+ students introductory formal logic, discrete mathematics, and statistics.

Publications

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Dexter Williams. Decorum in the Forum: Emotional Interactions in U.S. Presidential Press Conferences. *Arguing Democracy*. Proceedings of the 2025 NCA/AFA argumentation conference (Alta). Forthcoming from Taylor & Francis.

Heng Zheng, **Dexter Williams**, Bertram Ludäscher (2025). Using LLMs to Model Arguments in U.S. Supreme Court Briefs: Preliminary Report. *International Workshop on Translating Natural Legal Language into Formal Representation (NLL2FR 2025)* at the *Thirty-eighth International Conference on Legal Knowledge and Information Systems (JURIX 2025)*.

POSTERS

Heng Zheng, **Dexter Williams**, Bertram Ludäscher (2025). Modeling U.S. Supreme Court Briefs with Computational Argumentation. *Thirty-eighth International Conference on Legal Knowledge and Information Systems (JURIX 2025)*.

Dexter Williams (2024). Assessing the Quality of Pathotic Arguments. *2024 iSchool Research Showcase at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign*.

IN REVIEW

Dexter Williams. That Feels Convincing: Assessing the Quality of Pathotic Arguments. *Argumentation in the Digital Society*. Proceedings of the 5th European Conference on Argumentation (ECA 2025).

Fellowships, Awards, & Honors ---

FELLOWSHIPS

2024	Informatics Recruitment Fellowship , University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	\$ 30,000
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AWARDS

2025	iSchool Conference Presentation Award , University of Wisconsin-Madison	\$ 1,612
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2025	Informatics Conference Presentation Award , University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	\$ 1,000
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HONORS

2018-2022	Dean's List , University of St Andrews
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Mentoring ---

2025-2026	Undergraduate Independent Study , Supervisor, University of Wisconsin-Madison
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2021	St Andrews Mentoring Initiative , Mentor, University of St Andrews
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2020	Coronavirus Tutoring Initiative , Tutor
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Service ---

PEER REVIEWER

15th edition of the Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)

The 13th Workshop on Argument Mining (ArgMining 2026)

The 12th Workshop on Argument Mining (ArgMining 2025)